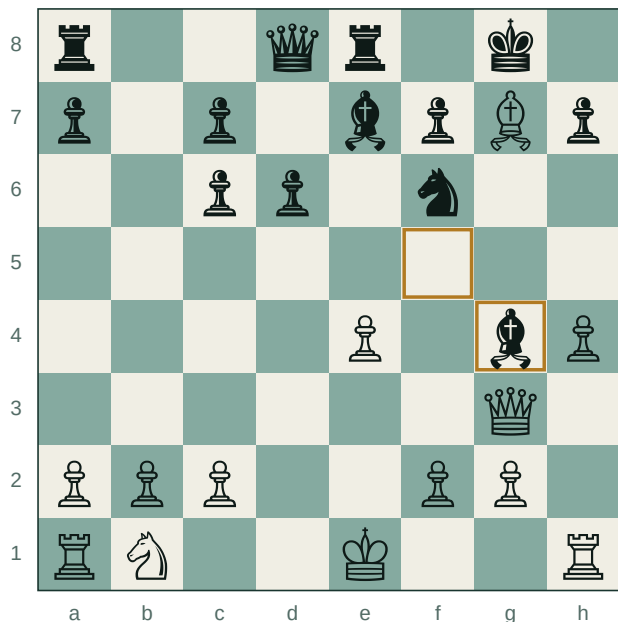


# Capture the defender: White, move 13

Capture the defender

White to move



Previous move: 12...Bg4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

## 13. Bxf6 Bxf6 14. Qxg4+

**13.Bxf6** The bishop captures the knight on f6. Recorded reply: **13...Bxf6**.

**14.Qxg4+** Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on g4.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

### CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -2 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

### CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not assume a defender is unique. Another piece may take over its job, or the opponent may decline to recapture.

### WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Removing a key defender can transform a protected square into a winning entry. The defender's function explains why the first capture matters.

### HOW TO LOOK

Identify the protected target, capture its essential defender, and calculate the follow-up after each plausible recapture.

The defending king is on g8. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.